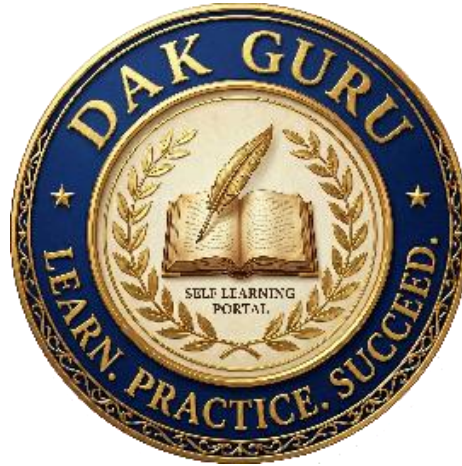


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MNOP, PNOP & MPOP

Mail & Parcel Network Optimization — Operations, KPIs, Hubs, Delivery & Design Manual

For LDCE Inspector Posts (IP) & PS Group 'B' Examinations

Updated as on June 2026 (latest orders incorporated)

DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate the latest changes, amendments, circulars and notifications relating to the relevant Acts, Rules, Regulations and Departmental orders, this document is intended as a study aid only. Postal networks, hub structures and operational norms are presently undergoing active restructuring under MPOP, so figures may change. Readers and students are strongly advised to refer to official Government sources, gazette notifications and Directorate orders for the most reliable and authoritative information.

Key Updates at a Glance (2024–2026)

The mail and parcel network is being significantly restructured. The following recent developments — verified against Directorate orders — materially affect the older MNOP/PNOP figures and must be kept in mind while studying. A full, dedicated treatment of the finalized MPOP network and of IDCs is given in **Part F** and **Part B** respectively.

MNOP + PNOP have been merged into MPOP — Mail & Parcel Optimization Project

The Department, in collaboration with M/s McKinsey & Company India LLP (engaged November 2024), has launched the **Mail and Parcel Optimization Project (MPOP)** as the successor framework that combines mail (erstwhile MNOP) and parcel (erstwhile PNOP) optimization into a single end-to-end programme covering First Mile, Middle Mile and Last Mile, with automation, standardized workflows, parcel sorters and real-time tracking.

A **Change Management Workshop for MPOP** was held on **11 December 2025**.

Rationalization of Mail Hubs (NSH → ICH) — being done in phases

Phase 1 — 20 NSHs downgraded to ICHs: Vide OM No. 30-37/2025-D dated 29.10.2025 (DDG, Mail Operations), 20 NSHs were downgraded to ICHs, effective **15 November 2025**, with no displacement of staff. Downgraded NSHs (one per Circle): Kurnool, Dibrugarh, **Barauni**, Bilaspur, Vadodara, Leh, Jamshedpur, Arsikere, Thrissur, Jabalpur, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, Aizawl, Rourkela, Amritsar, Ajmer, **Tirunelveli (Tamil Nadu)**, Warangal, Saharanpur, Rudrapur and Burdwan.

Phase 2 — 27 NSHs to be downgraded to ICHs: Vide File No. Mail-30-37/2025-D-DoP dated 28.01.2026, after a reference letter dated 24.12.2025 had identified 34 NSHs and following VCs on 06.01.2026 & 21.01.2026, it was decided to downgrade 27 NSHs to ICHs, effective **03 February 2026**. A threshold of **50 articles/day** applies for retaining direct Speed Post bagging to an NSH outside the parent Circle.

Rationale: ~85% of Speed Post mail is from bulk customers; **58 bulk-booking centres book 60–70% of mail** and keep direct-bagging facility; ~80–90% mail originates from 10–12 major cities.

Finalized Parcel Network under MPOP (F.No. 39-04/2025-PD dated 17.10.2025)

The revised parcel network has been **finalised with 40 L1 parcel hubs and 127 L2 parcel hubs**. Per the Hon'ble Minister's direction, the number of **L1 hubs is capped at not more than 45** (a Departmental dashboard item).

Every PIN code will be directly mapped to an L1 hub, which will do direct sorting for its catchment — requiring full automation and larger hubs. Linkages are **state-agnostic** (logistics-driven), aligned with e-commerce fulfillment centres (Amazon/Flipkart), district GDP growth, telecom density, and highway/airport connectivity.

Implementation is tied to the **Postal Logistics Infrastructure Project (PLIP)** — construction & automation of **40 L1 hubs over ~5 years**. Until then, the **current PNOP network (79 L1 + 109 L2 hubs) continues** to ensure continuity of service.

Parcel handling is projected to rise from **~3.5 lakh parcels/day (current)** to **~35 lakh parcels/day (~10×)** in the proposed network.

Independent / Integrated Delivery Centres (IDC) — Memo No. 16-01/2025-D dated 14.01.2025

The Department is setting up **Independent Delivery Centres (IDCs)** to centralise delivery of **all article types** (Speed Post, Registered, parcels, ordinary mail) and separate the delivery function from front-end (counter) operations, on CEP-industry lines.

Each IDC will cover **50–80 delivery beats** with dedicated supervisory & operational staff. **NDCs will be merged with, or co-located with, IDCs** as integrated facilities.

Targets: **50 Greenfield IDCs** (new construction) + **1,800 brownfield IDCs** (existing buildings), each **~1,500–3,000 sq. ft**, over **2025-26 to 2028-29** under the Postal Infrastructure Management Scheme / PLIP. The Department also plans **~2,000 Delivery Centres (DCs)** over five years, reducing delivery offices from **~19,500 to ~12,000**.

Post Office Regulations, 2024 — all parcels are accountable

Under the **Post Office Act, 2023** and the **Post Office Regulations, 2024**, all parcels are now classified as **accountable articles** to provide tracking for every parcel. The earlier **ordinary (unregistered) parcel** product has been **discontinued**.

Rationalization of postal services vide **Gazette Resolution No. 218 dated 18.08.2025 (w.e.f. 01.10.2025)**: Speed Post is now the base single accountable mail service in the document segment (with Registration as a value-added feature); new premium products '**24 Speed Post**' and '**48 Speed Post**' have been introduced.

Note on figures: Hub counts are dynamic and have been revised repeatedly. The legacy MNOP figure of 95 NSHs / 163 ICHs reflects the position circulated around 01.04.2025; intervening orders record other counts (e.g., 94 NSHs / 149 ICHs / 96 Registered L1 / 216 Registered L2 as per OM dated 17.10.2024), followed by Phase-1 (20 NSHs from 15.11.2025) and Phase-2 (27 NSHs from 03.02.2026) downgrades. Where a specific number is asked in an exam, prefer the figure stated in the latest order available to you and treat all counts as subject to ongoing MPOP rationalization.

Part A — Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP)

Introduction and Scope

The **Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP)** was initiated as part of an **11th Plan scheme in March 2010** and adopted by the Department of Posts in **November 2010** to bring efficiency, transparency and accountability to mail operations. It was conceived with consultancy support from **M/s McKinsey & Company**. MNOP was **initially implemented for Speed Post** and was **later extended to Registered articles**. (As noted in Part 'Key Updates', MNOP and PNOP have since been consolidated under MPOP.)

Key Changes and Benefits

The implementation of MNOP introduced several key changes and benefits to India Post:

1. Simplification of Network

The Speed Post network was optimized by creating **National Sorting Hubs (NSHs)** and **Intra-Circle Hubs (ICHs)**, replacing the earlier structure of **315 National Speed Post Centres (NSPC)** and **890 State Speed Post Centres (SPC)**. The legacy MNOP literature quotes **95 NSHs and 163 ICHs** (position around 01.04.2025). This consolidation makes tracking of delayed or misplaced consignments far simpler.

Latest position — hub counts

OM dated 17.10.2024: 94 NSHs (incl. 2 APS hubs), 149 ICHs, 96 Registered L1 (incl. 2 APS), 216 Registered L2.

From 15.11.2025 (OM 30-37/2025-D): 20 NSHs downgraded to ICHs under MPOP — counts reduced accordingly.

2. Use of Adequate Equipment

Infrastructure upgradation at mail offices under MNOP includes the introduction of new equipment to improve not only the efficiency and effectiveness of staff but also their working conditions.

3. Optimisation of Layout

The layout of Speed Post hubs was redesigned to facilitate an **assembly-line flow of mail**, minimizing wasteful movement and maximizing space utilization. This ensures a clearly identified and defined flow of volume from origin to destination.

4. Streamlining of Processes

- **Unique Mail Pattern:** A mail-routing system designed for **PAN (Presence Across Nation)** India coverage, reducing the complexity of the working network.
- **Transit Time Targets:** Targets for each NSH are set based on mail-network availability and geographical location.
- **Sorting Schedule:** Speed-Net **NTD (Non-Town Delivery)** sorting is scheduled before **TD (Town Delivery)** sorting to optimize **D+X** delivery norms.
- **Rationalized Logic:** Sorting logic is rationalized based on actual volume reported.
- **Specialization:** Labour is specialized into **scanners** and **sorters**.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) – Overview

The following targets are established for the principal metrics. **Eleven (11) unique KPIs** are computed automatically on the Central Server, with performance of each Speed Post hub reviewed **every fortnight**.

Sr.	Key Performance Indicator	Target
1	D+X (NTD)	Average 2 days
2	D+X (TD)	Average 1.28 days
3	Inbound operational performance	100% (implied)
4	Share of bags without 'correct' bag labels	0%

Additional KPI Targets

KPI	Target
Share of 'mis-sorted' articles (NTD)	1%
Share of 'mis-sorted' articles (TD)	5%
Share of articles with 'missing' PIN codes	1%
Share of duplicate barcodes	0%
Full Scan Compliance (TD)	90%
Full Scan Compliance (NTD)	80%
TD articles without Delivery Scan / Information	5%

Establishment of Performance Reviews

Performance of each Speed Post hub is monitored and reviewed **every fortnight** based on KPIs computed using information on the **Central Server**. The **11 unique KPIs** ensure that every mail activity is tracked — transit time, scan compliance, mis-sorts, duplicate barcodes, missing PIN codes and invalid bag-labels.

Effective Monitoring Tools

- **BI Tool** — Business Intelligence.
- **IPVS** — India Post Visibility System.
- **AWB Tracking** — Air Waybill tracking.

Update: Real-time tracking and digitization are now driven by the **Advanced Postal Technology (APT 2.0)** platform introduced in 2025 under DOP IT 2.0.

Implications of MNOP KPIs (RMS Units)

KPI #1 — D+X (TD)

- **Definition:** Average time, in days, taken for **TD articles** from booking by the customer to delivery to the recipient.
- **Scope:** Articles booked at offices in the local TD/catchment area of a given NSH and delivered at Post Offices in the local TD/catchment area of the **same** NSH.

KPI #2 — D+X (NTD)

- **Definition:** Average time, in days, taken by **NTD articles** from booking by the customer to delivery to the recipient.
- **Scope:** Articles booked at offices in the local TD/catchment area of a given NSH (sorting hub) and delivered at Post Offices in the catchment area of NSHs **other than** the given NSH.
- **Implication:** Time for processing of articles after receipt at processing units and connection to available flight/schedules is counted for **D+X**.

KPI #3 — Inbound Operational Performance

- **Definition:** Performance of the destination hub to deliver all inbound TD articles in the **next possible delivery round**.
- **Cut-off — Metros:** All articles received at the sorting hub from **7:00 AM on day D-1 to 7:00 AM on day D**.

- **Cut-off — Non-Metros:** All articles received at the sorting hub from **3:00 AM on day D-1 to 3:00 AM on day D**.
- **Implication:** Time for processing of bags received before cut-off and their connection to schedules for same-day delivery is calculated.

KPI #4 — Share of Bags Without Correct Bag Labels

- **Definition:** All bags closed at the processing hub (with a bag-closing scan in the system) are checked for the correctness of their Bag ID.
- **Implication:** Processing units must use correct bag labels by category of article:

Article Category	Bag-label Prefix Format
Speed Post Document & Parcel and RL	EB_1234567890
Registered Packets (RP)	RB_1234567890
India Post Parcel	CB_1234567890
Ordinary Letter	LB_1234567890

KPI #5 — Share of Mis-sorted Articles (NTD)

- **Definition:** For all bags closed at a sorting hub, the bag label holds the delivery sorting hub information. The PIN code of the delivery PO of an article is compared with the delivery POs mapped to the destination sorting hub to which the article is bagged.
- **Logic:** If the delivery-PO PIN differs from the PINs of delivery POs mapped to that destination sorting hub, the article is treated as an **NTD mis-sort**.

KPI #6 — Share of Mis-sorted Articles (TD)

- **Definition:** The **6-digit PIN code** of the PO to which the article is bagged is compared with the PIN of the PO at which it is delivered. If they differ, it is a **TD mis-sort**.
- **Implication:** This KPI pertains to all articles mis-sorted at processing units during sorting and bag closing.

KPI #7 — Share of Articles with Missing PIN Codes

- **Definition:** Assesses how many articles were booked at POs/booking units in the catchment area of the sorting hub **without a 6-digit addressee PIN code**.

KPI #8 — Share of Duplicate Barcodes

- **Definition:** Assesses how many articles were booked by **reusing barcodes** within a prescribed time.
- **Implication:** Bulk-booking units (e.g., BNPL) booking with wrong PINs or duplicate barcodes adversely affect this KPI.

Scan Compliance Protocols**KPI #9 — Full Scan Compliance (TD)**

Percentage of TD articles having **all 8 scans** out of total articles delivered.

The 8 mandatory scans for TD articles:

1. PO/Sorting Hub Booking Scan
2. PO/Sorting Hub Dispatch Scan
3. Sorting Hub MA/TMO Receipt Scan
4. Sorting Hub Bag Opening Scan
5. Sorting Hub Bag Closing Scan
6. Sorting Hub MA/TMO Dispatch Scan
7. Delivery PO Receipt Scan
8. Delivery PO Final Delivery Scan

Mandatory scans for BNPL TD articles — 5 scans:

1. Article Booking Scan
2. Article Dispatch Scan
3. Mail Agency Dispatch Scan
4. Article Receipt at Post Office Scan
5. Delivery Scan at Post Office

KPI #10 — Full Scan Compliance (NTD)

Percentage of NTD articles having **all 12 scans** out of total articles delivered.

The 12 mandatory scans for NTD articles:

1. PO/Sorting Hub Booking Scan
2. PO/Sorting Hub Dispatch Scan

3. Origin Sorting Hub MA/TMO Receipt Scan
4. Origin Sorting Hub Bag Opening Scan
5. Origin Sorting Hub Bag Closing Scan
6. Origin Sorting Hub MA/TMO Dispatch Scan
7. Destination Sorting Hub MA/TMO Receipt Scan
8. Destination Sorting Hub Bag Opening Scan
9. Destination Sorting Hub Bag Closing Scan
10. Destination Sorting Hub MA/TMO Dispatch Scan
11. Destination PO Receipt Scan
12. Destination PO Final Delivery Scan

Implication: Of these, **4 scans** are mandatory for **each** processing unit (origin & destination): Bag Receipt, Bag Opened, Bag Closed and Bag Despatch.

Mandatory scans for BNPL NTD articles — 9 scans:

1. Article Booking Scan
2. Article Dispatch Scan
3. Mail Agency Dispatch Scan
4. Bag Receipt Scan at Destination NSH
5. Articles Receipt Scan at NSH
6. Articles Dispatch Scan at NSH
7. Bag Dispatch Scan at NSH
8. Article Receipt at Post Office Scan
9. Delivery Scan at Post Office

KPI #11 — TD Articles Without Delivery Scan / Information

- **Definition:** For TD articles, the percentage of articles booked on a given date that get scanned for **final delivery within the next 5 working days**.
- **Implication:** If TD articles received at the processing unit are not processed and connected to available schedules in time, this KPI is affected.

Project Objectives and Coverage

MNOP Project Components

- Optimization and consolidation of the mail-operation network across the country.
- Process redesign in mail operations for greater efficiency.
- Standardization of processes.
- Development of an effective online performance-monitoring system based on KPIs.

MNOP Project Coverage

The entire country — covering Speed Post and unregistered mail — was brought into the fold after the product and network revamp.

MNOP Concept — Network Structure (as circulated w.e.f. 01.04.2025)

The legacy structure under MNOP/PNOP, as circulated for 01.04.2025, is given below. **These figures are now under MPOP rationalization** (see Key Updates).

Sl.	Mail Item	NSHs / L1 / NPH	ICHs / L2 / PH
1	Speed Post Document, Registered Letter	95 NSHs	163 ICHs
2	First Class Unregistered	96 L1	207 L2
3	Second Class Unregistered	96 L1	207 L2
4	Speed Post Parcel & India Post Parcel (189 PHs total)	79 NPH	110 PH

Delivery Norms of All Types of Articles

Indicative delivery norms (in days). The six metro cities referenced are **Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Bengaluru, Kolkata and Hyderabad**.

Type of Article	Local	Between Metros	Same State	Neighbouring State	Rest of Country
First Class (Registered)	2	2–3	3–4	3–4	5–6
First Class (Unregistered)	2	2–3	3–4	3–4	5–6
Second Class	3	4	4	4	5–7
India Post Parcel	2–3	3–4	4	4	5–7
Speed Post	1–2	1–3	1–4	1–4	4–5

Note: "Local" = within municipal city limit. Following the rationalization of postal services (Gazette Resolution No. 218 dated 18.08.2025, w.e.f. 01.10.2025) and the new

premium products '24 Speed Post' / '48 Speed Post', delivery commitments for some products are being revised — verify the current tariff/SLA before quoting.

Features of the Monitoring System

- Performance monitoring of each hub based on **11 different KPIs** (transit time, scan compliance, delivery-office performance, use of PIN code, mis-sorts, etc.).
- **No human intervention** in data extraction and no scope for manipulation of the system.
- **24×7** online availability of data with user credentials at all levels.
- Enables field units to find weak elements in the chain and take effective remedial action.
- Performance monitoring through **video conference every fortnight**, chaired by the Secretary (Posts).

Achievements Under the Scheme

- Reduced transit time and improved delivery performance for Speed Post across the country (more than **60%** of articles delivered within **two days** of booking).
- Improved visibility for Speed Post articles on the India Post tracking system (end-to-end status available online for about **89%** of Speed Post articles).
- Standardized processes at Speed Post operations leading to streamlined operations, better monitoring and enhanced productivity.
- New tools and equipment leading to better working conditions for employees.
- **Improved sorting process:** volume-based sorting logic introduced; a sorting diagram designed to suit this logic; a new sorting case designed.
- **Adequate equipment & infrastructure:** new roller containers, trays, trolleys and bag cutters; computers, scanners, printers and internet connectivity provided.
- The online KPI tool provided an effective mechanism for performance measurement at all management levels.
- The complaint-handling system became very effective and responsive.

Modernising the Look & Feel of Mail Offices

MNOP provided for improving the ambiance of mail offices — improved look-and-feel and greater trustworthiness and reliability by upgrading processing facilities.

Award for the MNOP Concept

The **National e-Governance Award 2012-13** under the category "Outstanding performance in citizen-centric service delivery", by the **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, Government of India, was awarded to the Department of Posts for the MNOP initiative.

Part B — Delivery Policies (Two-Wheeler & BYOD)

Policy on Delivery of Postal Articles Through Own Two-Wheeler Vehicle

The following categories of delivery staff in Departmental Post Offices (including Nodal Delivery Centres) are covered:

- Regular Postman staff.
- Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)/ABPM, including GDS Mail Carrier (MC).
- Other Departmental staff engaged for delivery work.
- Outsourced delivery staff.

Postman Ad-hoc Establishment Norms for 2-Wheeler (Mechanized) Delivery Beats

S.No.	Mode	Congested area (min)	Non-congested area (min)	Remark
1	Distance travelled by Foot	19 min/km	12 min/km	Ad-hoc norms
2	By Bicycle	10 min/km	6 min/km	—
3	By 2-wheeler vehicle	5 min/km	3 min/km	—

Modalities for Reimbursement of Fuel Charges — Documents to be Checked

Before allowing reimbursement, the **APM (Delivery)/Postmaster** (or supervising official) must check and keep in the guard file at the Delivery Post Office:

- Valid 2-wheeler driving licence in the name of the person doing delivery.
- Copy of the Registration Certificate of the 2-wheeler.
- Copy of the insurance certificate of the 2-wheeler.
- The vehicle should be owned by the delivery staff or by an immediate family member.

- If owned by an immediate family member, a declaration to that effect from the delivery staff is to be obtained and placed in the guard file.
- If not owned by the delivery staff or an immediate family member, an authorization letter from the vehicle owner (in the name of the delivery staff) is to be obtained and kept on record.

Note: While allowing fuel reimbursement to a GDS MC, Circles must also rationalize the number of GDS MCs required to carry the BO bag to Branch Post Offices, considering the time saved through mechanization.

Calculation of Average Distance Travelled in Beat

- **Observation Period:** average distance travelled by the delivery staff over **6 working days**.
- Distance via 2-wheeler is checked daily by the APM (Delivery)/Postmaster or supervising official.
- Meter readings before departure and after return are recorded in a register.
- Any complete week of **6 working days** may be selected by the Postal Division as the observation period.
- The exercise may preferably be carried out in **April** of each year.

Linkage with Mobile App Usage

Payment of reimbursement is linked to usage of the **Postman Mobile App (IMA)**. To be eligible, at least **95% of accountable articles** during the claim period must be processed through IMA.

Manner of Submission of Fuel Reimbursement Claim

The delivery staff submits the Fuel Reimbursement claim form (prescribed format) on the **1st working day** of the month for the previous month, with details of:

- Number of accountable articles delivered on each date.
- Delivery efficiency of accountable articles.
- Percentage of articles handled in IMA.
- Average distance per day for the month claimed.

Rate of Reimbursement of Fuel Charges

Rate = Average periodic-maintenance cost per km (**₹0.98**) + Average fuel charge per km.

- **Average fuel charge per km** = Fuel price in the respective stage ÷ Average mileage of the bike (taken as **40 km/litre**).

Linkage with Delivery Performance

S.No.	Delivery Performance (processing of articles)	Reimbursement
1	95% or more	100% of calculated charges
2	90% to 94.9%	80% of calculated charges

Action by APM (Mails)/Post Office In-charge

The APM (Delivery)/Postmaster randomly checks the genuineness of doorstep delivery of accountable articles for at least **5 accountable articles** from the delivery manifest, using the "**IMA-Beat Delivery Report**" on the CEPT MIS portal, on a **daily** basis.

Accounting and Payment of Fuel Reimbursement

- APM (Delivery)/Postmaster submits the bills to the Divisional Office for sanction by the **5th** of each month.
- Divisional Heads sanction the bills by the **10th** of each month.
- Payment to delivery staff is made monthly by the **15th**, after codal formalities, by Postmasters/In-charge NDCs.
- Expenditure is met from the Circle allotment under the head "**Office Expenses (OE)**".

Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Scheme

Under the **revised BYOD scheme (guidelines dated 25.06.2025)**, delivery staff (Postmen/GDS/outsourced) use their own smartphone to run DoP and IPPB apps.

Revised remuneration (w.e.f. 25.06.2025)

₹300 per smartphone per month for device usage (revised from ₹200).

₹200 per month for SIM/Data/Voice/SMS charges (revised from ₹150).

Total = ₹500 per month. Subject to a minimum of **90% of articles handled through IMA/PMA**.

- **Scope:** applicable only to Postmen/GDS doing delivery work who are not already provided a smartphone by the Directorate or IPPB; an **Android** smartphone meeting minimum configuration is required.
- **Security:** Mobile Device Management (MDM) software is installed by IPPB for security of the IPPB application.

Calculation of BYOD Remuneration in Special Cases

1. Device remuneration (when the phone is not used for part of the month due to absence, service/repair, etc.):

Remuneration = ₹300 × (No. of working days the phone was used) ÷ (No. of working days in the month).

2. Mobile-tariff remuneration:

Tariff = ₹200 × (No. of working days the phone was used) ÷ (No. of working days in the month).

3. Exceptional cases (full remuneration):

- (a) If the employee delivers articles using IMA at least once in the month, having processed a minimum of **90%** of articles, and then proceeds on duly sanctioned leave.
- (b) If delivery through IMA could not be done due to technical issues in the phone, and it is repaired within **2 working days** (a copy of the service/repair bill may be produced).
- If an outsourced staff's phone is used for IMA delivery in the absence of departmental staff, the outsourced staff may be remunerated for that period in the same manner.

Timeline for Processing of BYOD Reimbursement

S.No.	Activity	Timeline (on or before)
1	Verification of BYOD criteria — Supervisor/APM/PM verifies that ≥90% of articles were handled through IMA (via DPMS or IMA beat-delivery report), on a daily basis.	3rd working day of the month
2	Forwarding the claim of eligible delivery staff to the concerned PM/CPM/Div. Head.	5th working day of the month
3	Processing & sanctioning — sanctioning authority inspects records and ensures timely processing subject to availability of funds.	15th working day of the month

Independent / Integrated Delivery Centre (IDC)

To improve delivery performance on the lines of the Courier-Express-Parcel (CEP) industry, the Department has proposed **Independent Delivery Centres (IDCs)** for centralised delivery of **all types of articles** — Speed Post (document), Registered Post,

parcels and ordinary mail. The proposal was communicated vide **Memo No. 16-01/2025-D dated 14.01.2025** (Mail Operations Division).

Why IDCs — the Rationale

- At present India Post maintains a network of **~19,500 delivery Post Offices**, a majority of which are **single- or double-handed**, with a weak mechanism to supervise delivery work.
- There is a need to **separate the delivery function from front-end (booking-counter) operations**, so that delivery-specific tasks — Sunday/holiday delivery, a second delivery, early-morning or late-evening delivery — can be performed as in the CEP market.
- Delivery of parcels through **NDCs** has already improved parcel delivery; IDCs extend this model to all articles.

Key Features of an IDC

- Each IDC will comprise **50 to 80 delivery beats**; the delivery jurisdiction of existing delivery Post Offices will be **merged into the IDC**.
- Each IDC will have **dedicated supervisory staff** and other operational staff.
- **NDCs already operationalised** for parcels will be **merged with, or co-located with, IDCs**, in line with the policy of setting up integrated facilities.
- Each IDC will occupy **~1,500 sq. ft to 3,000 sq. ft** (depending on the number of beats), with parking for **2-wheeler and 4-wheeler** vehicles.
- **Mechanization is mandatory** for all delivery areas within IDCs; fuel reimbursement is available for staff using their own two-wheelers, with the possibility of India Post providing electric two-wheelers or hiring four-wheelers for larger parcels.

IDC Targets & Funding

Parameter	Detail
Greenfield IDCs	50 (involving construction of new IDC buildings)
Brownfield IDCs	1,800 (in existing buildings with civil/electrical upgrades)
Area per IDC	~1,500 – 3,000 sq. ft
Beats per IDC	50 – 80 delivery beats
Implementation period	2025-26 to 2028-29
Funding scheme	Postal Infrastructure Management Scheme / PLIP

Parameter	Detail
Land identification aid	List of 1,472 vacant land plots shared with Circles

IDC layout variants (per SOP / Policy Guidelines)

Integrated Delivery Centre with separate delivery staff for documents and parcels (separate teams in the same facility).

Integrated Delivery Centre with mixed delivery staff for both documents and parcels (same staff handle both).

Where space requires, document and parcel processing may be in **separate areas/compounds**, designated as 'Delivery Centres' and 'Nodal Delivery Centres'. Ideally, the two processing areas should be **adjacent**.

Terminology note: 'IDC' is officially the **Independent Delivery Centre** (Memo No. 16-01/2025-D). The SOP also uses **Integrated Delivery Centre** for the layout where document and parcel delivery are combined under one roof. The broader MPOP/PLIP papers also refer to ~2,000 **Delivery Centres (DCs)** planned over five years, which would bring delivery offices down from ~19,500 to ~12,000.

Part C — Parcel Network Optimization Project (PNOP)

Parcel Sales Manual — Overview

- PNOP was undertaken by the Department (**launched 17.08.2018**) to streamline parcel operations, with the vision to capture at least **15% of the CEP (Courier, Express & Parcel) market share by 2026**.
- Parcel business in India Post today focuses on **accountable parcel articles** — namely **Speed Post Parcel, India Post Parcel**, and commission earned from **COD parcels** in different categories.
- **Ordinary parcel** was not an accountable article and offered no value-added service or traceability; this product has been **discontinued** after the coming into force of the **Post Office Regulations, 2024** — under which **all parcels are now accountable articles**.

Latest position — PNOP is now part of MPOP

PNOP (parcel) and MNOP (mail) are now consolidated under the **Mail & Parcel Optimization Project (MPOP)**. A new automation-led parcel network (L1 capped at 40, direct PIN-to-L1 mapping, state-agnostic linkages) is being designed under **F.No. 39-04/2025-PD dated 17.10.2025**; the existing 79 L1 / ~110 L2 network continues during the ~5-year transition.

Sales Activity

Sales activities are designed to acquire customers and achieve pre-defined sales targets, organized into three types: **Sales Target, Sales Process and Sales Monitoring**.

1. Sales Target

- The annual sales target for parcel business is decided by the **Parcel & Citizen-Centric Services Directorate** and allotted to Circles.
- The Division further allocates **bulk** sales targets to Marketing Executives and **retail** targets to subordinate post offices.
- **Focus:** only on **bulk sales** (corporate customers), not retail.
- **Bulk definition:** customers giving business of **₹10,000 and above per month** and availing the contractual services of the Department.

Marketing Executive (ME)

- Postal Assistant, Sorting Assistant or PRI may be designated as ME by the Division.
- Some Circles use the nomenclature **Area Manager** or **Relationship Manager** instead of ME.
- There is no specific qualification for ME; selection should be based on calibre and competence. MEs should preferably be **full-time**.
- **Good target for an ME:** close **two sales in one week**, i.e., **100 new bulk customers in a year**.

Timeline for Allocation of Annual Sales Target

Sr.	Activity	Timeline
1	Allocation of yearly target to Circles by Parcel & Citizen-Centric Services Directorate	Before 5th April
2	Allocation of monthly target to Regions by Circles	Before 10th April
3	Allocation of monthly target to Divisions by Regions (or Circles, if Division is directly under a Circle)	Before 15th April
4	Allocation of monthly target to MEs by Divisions	Before 25th April

- **Review & feedback:** preferably in **December**, so inputs feed into decisions for the next financial year.

2. Sales Process

The sales process has **six stages**:

- 1. Prospecting** — lead generation; pool of leads; selecting qualified leads.
- 2. Preparation** — research on qualified leads; obtain appointment; prepare for presentation.
- 3. Presentation** — introduce self & organisation; understand requirements; explain business proposition; present products & services; provide value proposition; collect market intelligence.
- 4. Managing objections** — prepare likely queries; resolve queries; document queries.
- 5. Closing** — deal closure; contract signing; post-sales transfer of responsibility.
- 6. Follow-up** — relationship management (KAM); up-sell & cross-sell; referrals.

Activity Flow for Prospecting

Identify leads: MEs identify industries and service-sector companies/entities in the assigned geography that have potential to become DoP clients.

Collection of information (secondary research methods):

- **Cold canvassing** — traditional (generally by phone). Sources: telephone directory, publications of local market associations, RWAs, etc.
- **Referrals** — from current customers, local contacts/network and other leads; also from online/website queries, phone queries from staff and call-centre queries.
- **Local field offices** — regular contact with local postal staff (Postman, PRIs, recently-retired staff) to gather details of bulk customers.
- **Web-based research** — search engines/sites such as Google, Justdial, Udaan, Yellow Pages, IndiaMART, TradeIndia, Quikr, OLX, Sulekha, Facebook Marketplace, Instagram/WhatsApp.
- **Web & variable-data printers/publishing houses** — all printing and publishing houses are potential customers (e.g., banks and insurance companies printing stationery at a single location).

3. Sales Monitoring

The online dashboard created by **CEPT (apps.cept.gov.in)** gives ready access to all administrative units for monitoring.

Sales Team Members

- **KAM (Key Account Manager):** appointed by the Division Office for each bulk customer acquired; supervises the Operations SPOC and handles billing, value-adds, etc. Preferably at **ASP / ASRM / Dy. Supdt.** level.
- **SPOC (Single Point of Contact):** appointed by the Division Office for operations support; empowered to arrange equipment, manpower, pick-up, etc. Can be **PA / SA / IPO / IRM / ASRM** level.
- **ME (Marketing Executive):** identifies leads, prepares, presents, manages queries and closes deals.

Responsibility Matrix for Customer Acquisition

Approximate Monthly Demand Value	Official to Make Presentation
≤ ₹5 lakh per month (≤ ₹60 lakh p.a.)	Marketing Executive
> ₹5 lakh and ≤ ₹8 lakh per month (> ₹60 lakh and ≤ ₹1 crore p.a.)	Divisional Head
> ₹8 lakh per month (> ₹1 crore p.a.)	Regional Head

Good Targets

- **Lead-generation target:** each ME should identify basic information on **two leads daily** (≈ 50 leads/month, 600 leads/year); at least **50%** should be qualified.
- **Qualified-lead criteria:** projected monthly business of **₹10,000 and above**.
- **ME sales target:** close **2 sales per week** (100 new bulk customers per year).

Tips for Presentation — the 10-20-30 Rule

- No more than **10 slides**.
- Lasting not more than **20 minutes**.
- Font size not less than **30 points**.

Part D — Parcel Hub Network, NDC & Processing

Parcel Hub Network Structure

A separate parcel network of **189 Parcel Hubs** — comprising **79 NPH/Level-1 (L1)** and **110 PH/Level-2 (L2)** hubs — has been approved (position as on 01.04.2025). Speed Post Parcel and India Post Parcel are processed in Parcel Hubs.

Latest position

Earlier PNOP literature also records **57 L1 and 137 L2** parcel hubs; subsequent statements give **79 L1 and ~109–110 L2**. Under the new MPOP parcel plan, **L1 hubs are to be capped at 40** with direct PIN-to-L1 mapping, while the existing network continues during the ~5-year transition.

Bag Pattern for Processing All Types of Parcels

A. India Post Parcel

- PO to mapped Parcel Hub: separate **TD & NTD parcel bags**.
- Parcel Hub to Parcel Hub: **parcel bag**.
- Parcel Hub to mapped delivery PO/NDC: **parcel bag**.

B. Speed Post Parcel

- PO to mapped Parcel Hub: separate **TD & NTD Speed Post bags**.
- Parcel Hub to Parcel Hub: **Speed Post bag**.
- Parcel Hub to mapped delivery PO/NDC: **Speed Post bag**.

Bag-Label Colour Codes

- **Yellow:** Air connectivity (for Speed Post Parcel).
- **Blue:** Surface connectivity (for India Post Parcel).

Nodal Delivery Centre (NDC)

An NDC receives parcels, sorts them by delivery address, takes them out for delivery and stores/processes undelivered parcels.

- **Location criteria:** metros and other cities/towns where parcel density exceeds **1 parcel per sq. km**.
- **Space standard:** ideal NDC layout area is **1595 sq. ft**.

- **Postman delivery-bag norms:** dimension **45 cm × 35 cm × 56 cm**; bag weight **2 kg**; carrying capacity **30 kg**.

Total network: 233 NDCs covering 1600+ PIN-code areas, located in 145 cities.

Type of City	No. of NDCs
Tier-I	73
Tier-II	103
Tier-III	57

NDC → IDC integration (latest)

Under the IDC policy (**Memo No. 16-01/2025-D dated 14.01.2025**), **NDCs already operationalised for parcels are to be merged with, or co-located with, Independent/Integrated Delivery Centres (IDCs)** as part of the Department's integrated-delivery strategy. See Part B for the full IDC treatment.

Delivery Norms for NDCs

- **Two-wheelers:** 50–60 parcels in two trips (30–35 in the first trip, the rest in the second).
- **Four-wheelers:** used for bigger parcels (typically > 2 kg); target **70–80 such parcels** per four-wheeler.

Speed Post Articles Qualifying as Parcels

A Speed Post article qualifies as a parcel if **any one** of the following is met:

- Weight exceeds **500 grams**.
- Dimensions exceed **38 cm × 27 cm × 2 cm**.
- The customer declares the contents as **merchandise**.

Parcel Packaging Policy

There are three aspects of parcel packaging:

- **External packaging:** flyers, boxes, BOPP (Bi-axially Oriented Polypropylene) tapes, stretch-wrap plastic films & strapping rolls.
- **Internal packaging:** loose-fill such as bubble wrap, airbags & cardboard fillers.
- **Special-handling label:** labels indicating handling instructions for fragile items.

Specifications of Packaging Material

Type	Usage	Thickness	Carrying Capacity
Plastic Flyer/Bag	Securing parcels	55–60 microns	< 2 kg
Paper Flyer/Bag	Securing parcels	100–150 microns	< 2 kg
BOPP Tape	Securing & fastening	40 microns	—
Boxes	Protect parcel in transit	—	Single wall: 1, 2, 5, 10 kg; Double wall: 15, 25 & 35 kg

PNOP Dashboard

The **PNOP Dashboard** is set up by **CEPT, Mysuru** for better monitoring of project activities by the Parcel & Citizen-Centric Services Directorate. It monitors civil works, procurement of standardized equipment, and operationalization of Parcel Hubs and NDCs, and is updated by Circles daily.

Key data points for periodic update:

- **Layout design:** preparation, submission and approval.
- **Standard equipment:** assessment & procurement (opening tables, roller container, package trolley, bag stand, sorting case).
- **IT equipment:** computer & peripherals, barcode scanner, weighing machine including SWS/DWS.
- **Civil & electrical work:** site preparation.
- **Layout implementation:** actual implementation of approved layout with floor marking.
- **RTN movements:** option to update Road Transport Network movements to monitor adherence to time and schedule.

Required Operational Area for a Parcel Hub

Category	Operational Area	Processing Capacity (per 8-hr shift)	Throughput	Sort Destinations
1. Very-Small	575 sq. ft	Up to 500 parcels	≤ 120/hr	140
2. Small	1200 sq. ft	Up to 1500 parcels	121–250/hr	144
3. Medium	2840 sq. ft	Up to 3000 parcels	251–500/hr	180
4. Large	8456 sq. ft	Up to 8400 parcels	501–1400/hr	192

Static Weight System (SWS) Specifications

Parameter	Specification
Weight measurement unit	Grams (gms)
Dimension measurement unit	Millimetre (mm)
Maximum weight capacity	35 kg
Least count — weight	20 gms
Least count — dimension	10 mm or better
Minimum object size (L×B×H)	100 × 50 × 20 mm
Maximum object size (L×B×H)	600 × 600 × 600 mm
Data capture	Connection to PC; auto-transfer of weight/dimension within 1 second
Measurement time	Maximum 3 seconds
Platform size	Length/breadth at least 2 ft but not exceeding 2 ft 6 in
Warranty	One-year comprehensive + AMC/calibration

Parcel Sorting Case

- Standard preparation: **15 (5×3) pigeon holes.**
- Local customization: **12 (4×3) and 9 (3×3) pigeon holes.**

Presumptive Loss Policy

If a bag/parcel is not traced within **5 days**, presumptive loss is to be recovered from the officials at fault.

Calculation of presumptive loss:

- **Lost/abstracted parcel:** the maximum compensation the Department may have to pay the customer for that parcel.
- **Lost bag:** the maximum compensation the Department may have to pay for **all** the parcels invoiced in the bag.

Dealing with Inward Errors

1. **Office in-charge action:** on receiving an error report, the in-charge tries to resolve it based on available work papers.

- 2. RMS Office:** if unresolved, the Record Officer notifies the in-charge of the Set (MA in case of TMO) against which the error is made, within **2 days** of receipt; if the in-charge/MA fails to reply satisfactorily within **3 days**, the HRO/SRO initiates recovery of presumptive loss (if not already recovered).
- 3. Post Office:** if unresolved, the office in-charge initiates recovery of presumptive loss within **5 days** of receipt of error.
- 4. Divisional Office:** (a) monitors errors issued/received by offices under its control; (b) initiates recovery of presumptive loss from erring officials in a time-bound manner — recovery within **45 days** of the discrepancy; (c) maintains a register for monitoring recovery.

PNOP Forms List

S.No	Form	Description	Prepared At
1	1A	Receipt of Bag	Mail Agency/TMO, PO/NDC
2	1B	Despatch of Bag	Mail Agency/TMO, PO/NDC
3	1C	TB Dispatch	Mail Agency/TMO, PO/NDC
4	1D	TB Summary	Mail Agency/TMO, PO/NDC
5	1E	Bag Abstract	Mail Agency/TMO, PO/NDC
6	1F	Bag Abstract (where PH & MA work separately)	Parcel Hub
7	2A	Receipt of Article	Parcel Hub, PO/NDC
8	2B	Despatch of Article	Parcel Hub, PO/NDC
9	2C	Receipt & Despatch Summary	Parcel Hub
10	2D	Parcel Abstract	Parcel Hub, PO/NDC
11	3A	Inward Error Register	Record Office, PO
12	3B	Outward Error Register	Record Office, PO
13	3C	Inward Error Register	Record Office, PO
14	3D	Outward Error Register	Record Office, PO
15	3E	Inward Error Register	Division Office, PO
16	3F	Outward Error Register	Division Office, PO

KPIs to Review Booking, Despatch & Delivery Performance

There are a total of **33 KPIs** to monitor booking, despatch and delivery performance of Speed Post & India Post Parcel, developed by **CEPT/CSI**.

Part E — Trans-Shipment, JPP & Design / Operations Manuals

Trans-Shipment Centres under PNOP

The following **9 centres** are utilized for transportation of parcels/mails through the **Road Transport Network (RTN)**:

Centre	State	Centre	State
Guwahati	Assam	Nabadiganta	West Bengal
Sagar	Madhya Pradesh	Golconda	Telangana (Hyderabad)
Chennai	Tamil Nadu	Nagpur	Maharashtra
Siliguri	West Bengal	Ludhiana	Punjab
Bengaluru	Karnataka	—	—

Capacity (per trans-shipment centre):

- Movement of **5 trucks**.
- Storage of **1000 bags** (50 roller containers).
- **2 goods lifts** and vertical extension of **2 more floors**.

Joint Parcel Product (JPP): Express Cargo Service

- A collaborative parcel product of **India Post** and **Indian Railways**, covered under **PM Gati Shakti — National Master Plan for Multi-modal Connectivity**.
- First PoC run: **Surat to Varanasi on 31.03.2022**, with **8 tonnes** load in **Tapti Ganga Express (19045)**.
- Weight category: **35 kg to 100 kg**, from B2C & B2B, with focus on **MSMEs**.
- **India Post**: First-Mile collection/booking and Last-Mile delivery. **Indian Railways**: Middle-Mile transportation origin to destination.
- Booking on **PMS (Railways)** at the Aggregation Centre; parcels placed in specially-designed boxes/containers, locked and sealed by DoP in the presence of a Railway representative.
- **Third-party insurance** for end-to-end protection.

- Flexibility to opt out of First/Last Mile with relative discount. Per Directorate Letter No. 25-01/2022-D dated **28.10.2022**, the customer may opt for First-Mile and Last-Mile services as per requirement.

JPP Charges Structure

Activity	Amount incl. GST (₹/kg)
Only First Mile (pick-up, booking & handing over to Railways at origin)	4
Only Last Mile (booking, handing over at origin & delivery by destination centre)	4
First Mile + Last Mile (all activities)	6

Note: Insurance @ 0.03% of content value + GST @ 18% is levied in addition (through M/s Bajaj Allianz General Insurance Co. Ltd).

Middle-Mile Charges of Railway

- 10% over the scale applicable for that particular train.
- During the PoC: trains at "R" scale charged at **R + 10%**; trains at "P" scale at **P + 10%**.

Present Rate Structure — Tapti Ganga Express (19045), Surat → Varanasi

Train	Destination	Distance	Railway (incl. GST)	India Post (FM+LM)	Total/kg (incl. GST)
Tapti Ganga Exp. (19045)	Varanasi	1402 km	₹6.60	₹6.00	₹12.60

Parcel Hub & NDC Design Manual

Categorization of Parcel Hubs (by automation)

- **Manual parcel hub:** primary and secondary sorting done manually.
- **Semi-automated parcel hub:** primary sorting by an automated sorter (arm sorter, cross-belt sorter, tilt-tray sorter, pop-up sorter, etc.).
- **Automated parcel hub:** primary sorting by an automated sorter and secondary sorting done automatically or assisted by a **Put-To-Light (PTL)** system.

Operational Areas in a Parcel Hub Facility

1. **Bag Receipt Area** — closed bags are unloaded and received by the facility.
2. **Pre-Sort Staging Area** — received bags are stored/staged before further processing.

3. **Bag Opening Area** — bags opened, parcels taken out and received, then segregated as: **Forward** (onward delivery), **Return** (undelivered, to be returned), **Reject** (cannot be processed due to lack of data).
4. **Primary Sorting Area** — first-level (preliminary) sorting; may contain single/multiple secondary stations; may be clubbed with bag-opening depending on volume.
5. **Secondary Sorting Area** — second-level (detailed) sorting to respective destinations; includes closing parcels into bags, printing manifests, inserting manifests, and closing bags (system + physical seal). Weighing scales may be provisioned here or at post-sort staging.
6. **Returns Processing Area** — parcels marked for return to sender are processed before primary sorting or direct dispatch (consolidated returns for large senders).
7. **Large Parcel Processing Area** — separate area for parcels large enough to fill a single bag.
8. **Post-Sort Staging Area** — closed bags from secondary sorting/returns/large-parcel areas are sorted and staged by destination before dispatch.
9. **Bag Dispatch Area** — closed bags are loaded onto vehicles and dispatched.
10. **Data Admin & Booking Area** — data validation/correction/fresh entry; uploading XML files from bulk customers, etc.

Flow of Operational Activities

- **Bag Receipt:** vehicles arrive; bags unloaded & received.
- **Pre-Sort Staging:** bags arranged in trolleys by priority.
- **Primary Sorting:** bag opening, article receiving & primary sorting via sort application.
- **Secondary Sorting:** secondary sorting, bag closing & manifest printing.
- **Post-Sort Staging:** bag weighing, routing-label printing & pasting, bag staging.
- **Bag Dispatch:** bags loaded & dispatched; vehicles depart.

Key Operational Equipment in a Parcel Hub

Equipment	Purpose	Handling Capacity	Footprint
Roller Container	Moving closed bags / large parcels	20 closed bags × 10 parcels = 200 parcels (700 kg)	5 ft × 3 ft (15 sq. ft)
Package Trolley	Moving parcels within facility	Up to 50 parcels (300 kg)	3 ft × 2 ft (6 sq. ft)
Bag Opening Table	Opening bags & receiving parcels	250 or 350 parcels/hr (300 kg)	4 ft × 2.5 ft (10 sq. ft)
Bag Stand	Secondary sorting (high-volume) into bags	Holds 6, 8 or 10 bags	6 bags: 15.7 sq.ft; 8: 20.9; 10: 26
Sorting Case	Secondary sorting (low-volume)	Each pigeon hole: 16 parcels	9 holes: 8 sq.ft; 12: ~10.6; 15: 13.2
Computers	Processing parcels in the system	—	Stand 2 ft × 2 ft (4 sq.ft)
Thermal Printers	Bag labels / return routing labels	—	Peripheral
Printers	Bag manifest, delivery bill, etc.	—	Peripheral
IP-enabled weighing scale	Weighing closed bags	120 small / 150 large bags per hr	3 ft × 3 ft (9 sq.ft)
Static Weighing System (SWS)	Weight & dimensions for booking	≈ 360 parcels/hr	3 ft × 3 ft (9 sq.ft)
Table (Data Admin/Booking)	Processing; computer/printer placement	—	4 ft × 2 ft (8 sq.ft)

Key Aspects of Facility Design Specifications

Specification	Explanation
Volume	Number of parcels to be processed by the facility in different shifts (e.g., 3000 articles/shift). Ensures adequate equipment & space.
Operational Hours	Total hours in a shift during which all activities happen simultaneously (e.g., 6 actual operational hours in an 8-hour shift).
Throughput	Maximum parcels processed per hour; helps allocate equipment & space (e.g., 500 articles/hr).
Sort Destinations	Number of destinations to sort for (e.g., 160, including TD and NTD).

Floor-Marking Guidelines

Colour	Used to Mark
Blue	Processing areas — pre/post-sort staging, bag opening, sorting, data admin, booking, returns, bag receipt/dispatch, secure storage, stationery, etc.
Green	Equipment & workstations — roller containers, bag-opening table, package trolleys, bag stands, sorting case, sequencing tables, computer stands, SWS, weighing scale, racks, etc.
Yellow	Aisles — common passage, walking pathways, equipment-movement pathways, etc.

Areas That May Be Combined (by Category)

Category 1 ($\leq 120/\text{hr}$) & Category 2 (121–250/hr):

- May be separate: Secondary Sorting area.
- May be combined: bag receipt & dispatch (or at TMO); pre-sort & post-sort staging (or at TMO); bag opening + primary sorting + data admin & booking + returns + large-parcel processing — all into the bag-opening area.

Category 3 (251–500/hr):

- May be separate: pre-sort staging, secondary sorting, large-parcel processing.
- May be combined: bag receipt & dispatch; bag opening + primary sorting; data admin & booking + returns processing.

Category 4 (501–1400/hr): dedicated separate space for all areas; **none** may be combined.

Nodal Delivery Centre (NDC) — Activity Flow & Areas

Activity Flow in an NDC

- **Bag Receipt** → **Staging** → **Bag Opening** → **Parcel Receipt** (segregated: with data / no data) → **Sector Sorting** → **Beat Sorting** → **Beat Sequencing** → **Out for Delivery** → **Post-Delivery Attempt** (reconciliation, COD reconciliation, storing undelivered, processing/dispatch of returns).

Operational Areas in an NDC

- 1. Receipt & Dispatch Area** — closed bags unloaded & received; return bags dispatched & loaded.
- 2. Staging Area** — received bags staged before processing; return bags staged before dispatch.

3. **Bag Opening & Sector Sorting Area** — bags opened, parcels received & segregated into sectors (or marked reject if no data).
4. **Beat Sorting Area** — sector-sorted parcels further sorted into beats by delivery persons; beat sequencing; 'Out for Delivery' scan; parcels placed in delivery bag/van in LIFO order; delivery slip printed; one station typically allocated for large parcels delivered by van.
5. **Secure Parcel Storage Area** — undelivered parcels kept secure until re-attempt or return to origin.
6. **Data Admin Area** — data validation/correction/fresh entry; COD & undelivered-parcel reconciliation; processing of returns; treasury & data administration.
7. **Stationery Area** — stationery for processing parcels / delivery beats.

Key Operational Equipment in the NDC

Equipment	Purpose	Capacity	Footprint
Sequencing Table	Sequencing parcels already sorted by beat	60 parcels at a time (300 kg)	6 ft × 2 ft (12 sq.ft)
Angle Racks	Storing undelivered parcels in a lockable cage	Hold undelivered parcels for 7+ days	Three layers, each 1 ft 6 in high; first layer 1 ft from ground; top layer open for bigger parcels

Key Aspects of Facility Design Specifications (NDC)

Specification	Explanation
Volume	Parcels to be processed per shift and total across shifts; ensures adequate equipment (e.g., 1000 articles/shift).
Operational Hours	Hours during which bag opening, parcel receipt and sector sorting happen before handover to delivery persons. The delivery person should leave the facility within 1 hour of arrival (e.g., processing 2 hours/shift).
Throughput	Maximum parcels processed per hour at the bag-opening table (e.g., 500/hr → 1000 parcels in 2 hours).
Beats	Number of bike-delivery and van-delivery beats to sort for (e.g., 10 bike beats + 1 van beat for large parcels).

Parcel Operation Manual

The manual provides clear instructions on handling parcel products at each stage from booking to delivery, across **First Mile (booking)**, **Middle Mile (parcel sorting centre)** and **Last Mile (delivery office)**.

1. First Mile — Booking (Ad-hoc Norms)

- Booking of parcels: **48 parcels per hour**.
- Bagging: **60 seconds per bag**.
- Parcel bag dispatch scan: **4 bags per minute**.
- Parcel facility in-scan: **720 parcels/hour**.

2. Middle Mile — Parcel Sorting Centre

A. Manual Parcel Processing Centre — pre-sort staging is organised so that **FIFO (First-In-First-Out)** can be maintained while feeding bags to bag-opening/primary-sort stations.

Ad-hoc norms (manual):

- Parcel bag facility in-scan: **4 bags/min (15 sec/bag)**.
- Bag opening: **350 parcels/hr** (only bag opening + parcel-receipt scan at the table).
- Bag opening: **250 parcels/hr** (bag opening + parcel-receipt scan + primary sorting at the table).
- Parcel SWS weighment: **6 parcels/min**.
- Primary sorting: **700 parcels/hr**.
- Secondary sorting + bagging (directly into bags): **250 parcels/hr**.
- Sorting of bags for post-sort staging: **360 bags/hr**.
- Sorting & bagging at mixed station (into pigeon hole then bags): **150 parcels/hr**.
- Parcel bag dispatch scan: **4 bags/min (15 sec/bag)**.

B. Semi-Automated Parcel Processing Centre — ad-hoc norms:

- Parcel feeding on automated sorter: **1200 parcels/hr**.
- Primary sorting: as per the designed capacity of the automatic sorter.

3. Last Mile — Delivery Office

- The delivery bag/vehicle follows the **LIFO (Last-In-First-Out)** concept while loading individual parcels — the last parcel loaded is the first attempted for delivery.

- **Large parcels** for delivery purposes are those **above 2 kg** in weight (physical or volumetric).
- **Ad-hoc norm:** bag opening, parcel scanning and sector sorting — **250 parcels/hr.**

Part F — Finalized MPOP Network (Mail & Parcel)

This Part captures the **finalized parcel network under MPOP** as communicated by the Parcel Directorate vide **F.No. 39-04/2025-PD dated 17.10.2025**, together with the **mail-hub rationalization** (NSH → ICH) under **OM No. 30-37/2025-D**. These are the most current, primary-source figures available.

Objective & Design Principles

The objective of the exercise is to establish a **state-agnostic, industry-aligned and future-ready logistics backbone** for the Department of Posts, keeping in view e-commerce growth, time-bound delivery and optimal use of infrastructure. Identification of future L1 hubs followed a **five-fold approach**:

1. **E-commerce alignment** — network aligned with major e-commerce fulfillment centres (e.g., Amazon, Flipkart) so parcel flows match industry sources.
2. **District-level GDP growth** projections for the next five years, to cater to future demand hotspots.
3. **Telecom density** as a proxy for demand intensity (an evidence-based check on locations).
4. **Connectivity** by both surface and air — all hubs situated near national highways and airports.
5. **Strategic adjustments** to address land constraints and specific regional requirements.

Key Features of the Finalized Network

- **40 L1 parcel hubs and 127 L2 parcel hubs** in the finalised network. L1 count is **capped at not more than 45** per the Hon'ble Minister's direction (a Departmental dashboard item).
- **Direct PIN-code mapping**: every PIN code is mapped directly to an L1 hub, which carries out direct sorting for the PIN codes in its catchment. This needs **full automation and larger operational areas**, far exceeding present capacities.
- **Dynamic L1–L1 bagging**: not every L1 will close bags to every other L1; closures will be decided dynamically based on actual traffic, supported by technology-driven routing/optimization tools (a 'mesh' network in future).

- **L2–L2 bagging** is generally **not justified nationwide** (low average volumes of 10–15 parcels/day); allowed as an **exception in the North-East** due to connectivity, and elsewhere only where projected volume justifies it.
- **Tied to PLIP**: implementation depends on the **Postal Logistics Infrastructure Project (PLIP)** — construction & automation of **40 L1 hubs**, expected to take **~5 years**; complete switchover at the end of the PLIP cycle.
- **Interim continuity**: until then, the **current PNOP network (79 L1 + 109 L2 hubs)** continues to remain operational.
- **Surge handling**: bulk-booking offices may do **direct bagging** for surge volumes / special occasions (e.g., State examination boards, PM Vishwakarma consignments) on justified volume, sensitivity and consignment size.
- **Capacity jump**: parcel handling projected to rise from **~3.5 lakh/day** to **~35 lakh/day** ($\approx 10\times$); hence no large reduction in establishment is expected.
- **Delivery rationalization**: **~2,000 Delivery Centres (DCs)** planned over five years, reducing delivery offices from **~19,000 to ~12,000**.

BPC / BNPL Operations under the New Network

Business Post Centres (BPCs) and Book-Now-Pay-Later (BNPL) centres will operate in **two phases** — a transition phase (while parcel hubs are being built) and a post-setup phase (after 4–5 years). Future scenarios by hub location:

- **BPC/BNPL in an L1 city**: volumes from large bulk customers are picked up, loaded in trucks and dispatched directly to parcel hubs; for small/medium bulk customers, volumes are picked up or dropped off and consolidated to the L1 parcel hub.
- **BPC/BNPL in an L2 city**: the BPC/BNPL books and bags articles at **TD and NTD** level — TD bags are opened and processed at the L2 parcel hub, while NTD bags are forwarded to the mapped L1.
- **BPC/BNPL in a non-L1/L2 city**: articles are booked and bagged at **NTD** level; at **TD** level they are sorted to the **TD delivery centres**.

List of 40 L1 Parcel Hubs under MPOP (Annexure-I)

As finalized vide F.No. 39-04/2025-PD dated 17.10.2025:

S.No	Circle	L1 Hub	S.No	Circle	L1 Hub
1	Andhra Pradesh	Visakhapatnam	21	Maharashtra	Mumbai
2	Andhra Pradesh	Vijayawada	22	Maharashtra	Pune
3	Assam	Guwahati	23	Maharashtra	Nagpur
4	Assam	Silchar	24	Odisha	Bhubaneswar
5	Bihar	Patna	25	Punjab	Chandigarh
6	Chhattisgarh	Raipur	26	Punjab	Ludhiana
7	Delhi	Delhi NCR	27	Rajasthan	Jaipur
8	Gujarat	Rajkot	28	Rajasthan	Jodhpur
9	Gujarat	Ahmedabad	29	Tamil Nadu	Chennai
10	Gujarat	Bharuch	30	Tamil Nadu	Madurai
11	J&K	Jammu	31	Tamil Nadu	Coimbatore
12	J&K	Srinagar	32	Telangana	Hyderabad
13	Jharkhand	Ranchi	33	Uttar Pradesh	Agra
14	Karnataka	Hubballi	34	Uttar Pradesh	Kanpur
15	Karnataka	Bengaluru	35	Uttar Pradesh	Varanasi
16	Karnataka	Mangaluru	36	Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow
17	Kerala	Kochi	37	Uttarakhand	Dehradun
18	Madhya Pradesh	Indore	38	West Bengal	Kolkata
19	Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal	39	West Bengal	Durgapur
20	Maharashtra	Nashik	40	West Bengal	Siliguri

List of 127 L2 Parcel Hubs with L1 Mapping (Annexure-I)

Complete L2-to-L1 mapping in the finalized MPOP network:

S.No	Circle	L2 Hub	Mapped L1 Hub
1	Andhra Pradesh	Ananthapur	Bengaluru
2	Andhra Pradesh	Cuddapah	Chennai
3	Andhra Pradesh	Eluru	Vijayawada
4	Andhra Pradesh	Guntur	Vijayawada
5	Andhra Pradesh	Kurnool	Hyderabad
6	Andhra Pradesh	Nellore	Chennai
7	Andhra Pradesh	Ongole	Vijayawada
8	Andhra Pradesh	Rajahmundry	Visakhapatnam
9	Andhra Pradesh	Tirupati	Chennai
10	Assam	Dibrugarh	Guwahati
11	Assam	Jorhat	Guwahati
12	Assam	Tezpur	Guwahati
13	Bihar	Barauni	Patna
14	Bihar	Bhagalpur	Patna
15	Bihar	Chapra	Patna
16	Bihar	Gaya	Patna
17	Bihar	Kiul	Patna
18	Bihar	Muzaffarpur	Patna
19	Chhattisgarh	Bilaspur	Raipur
20	Chhattisgarh	Durg	Raipur
21	Gujarat	Anand	Bharuch
22	Gujarat	Bhavnagar	Ahmedabad
23	Gujarat	Bhuj	Rajkot
24	Gujarat	Jamnagar	Rajkot
25	Gujarat	Junagadh	Rajkot
26	Gujarat	Mehsana	Ahmedabad
27	Gujarat	Surat	Bharuch

S.No	Circle	L2 Hub	Mapped L1 Hub
28	Gujarat	Vadodara	Bharuch
29	Gujarat	Valsad	Bharuch
30	Haryana	Ambala	Chandigarh
31	Haryana	Gurgaon	Delhi NCR
32	Haryana	Hisar	Delhi NCR
33	Haryana	Karnal	Delhi NCR
34	Haryana	Rohtak	Delhi NCR
35	Himachal Pradesh	Hamirpur	Chandigarh
36	Himachal Pradesh	Shimla	Chandigarh
37	Jammu & Kashmir	Leh	Delhi
38	Jharkhand	Dhanbad	Durgapur
39	Jharkhand	Jamshedpur	Ranchi
40	Karnataka	Bagalkot	Hubli
41	Karnataka	Belagavi	Hubli
42	Karnataka	Davangere	Mangalore
43	Karnataka	Gulbarga	Hyderabad
44	Karnataka	Hosapete	Hubli
45	Karnataka	Mysore	Bengaluru
46	Karnataka	Tumkur	Bengaluru
47	Karnataka	Arsikere	Bengaluru
48	Kerala	Kollam	Kochi
49	Kerala	Kottayam	Kochi
50	Kerala	Kozhikode	Coimbatore
51	Kerala	Palakkad	Coimbatore
52	Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram	Kochi
53	Kerala	Thrissur	Kochi
54	Madhya Pradesh	Gwalior	Agra
55	Madhya Pradesh	Itarsi	Bhopal
56	Madhya Pradesh	Jabalpur	Bhopal

S.No	Circle	L2 Hub	Mapped L1 Hub
57	Madhya Pradesh	Katni	Bhopal
58	Madhya Pradesh	Ratlam	Indore
59	Madhya Pradesh	Satna	Varanasi
60	Maharashtra	Madgaon	Mumbai
61	Maharashtra	Ahmednagar	Pune
62	Maharashtra	Chandrapur	Nagpur
63	Maharashtra	CS Nagar	Nashik
64	Maharashtra	Jalgaon	Nashik
65	Maharashtra	Miraj	Pune
66	Maharashtra	Nanded	Nagpur
67	Maharashtra	Ratnagiri	Pune
68	Maharashtra	Satara	Pune
69	Maharashtra	Solapur	Pune
70	North East	Itanagar	Guwahati
71	North East	Imphal	Silchar
72	North East	Shillong	Guwahati
73	North East	Aizawl	Silchar
74	North East	Dimapur	Guwahati
75	North East	Agartala	Silchar
76	Odisha	Balangir	Raipur
77	Odisha	Berhampur	Bhubaneswar
78	Odisha	Cuttack	Bhubaneswar
79	Odisha	Jeypore	Visakhapatnam
80	Punjab	Amritsar	Ludhiana
81	Punjab	Bathinda	Ludhiana
82	Punjab	Jalandhar	Ludhiana
83	Punjab	Patiala	Ludhiana
84	Rajasthan	Alwar	Jaipur
85	Rajasthan	Bikaner	Jodhpur

S.No	Circle	L2 Hub	Mapped L1 Hub
86	Rajasthan	Falna	Jodhpur
87	Rajasthan	Kota	Jaipur
88	Rajasthan	Sikar	Jaipur
89	Rajasthan	Sri Ganganagar	Jodhpur
90	Rajasthan	Udaipur	Jodhpur
91	Tamil Nadu	Dharmapuri	Bengaluru
92	Tamil Nadu	Erode	Coimbatore
93	Tamil Nadu	Jolarpettai	Bengaluru
94	Tamil Nadu	Karaikudi	Madurai
95	Tamil Nadu	Salem	Coimbatore
96	Tamil Nadu	Thanjavur	Madurai
97	Tamil Nadu	Tirunelveli	Madurai
98	Tamil Nadu	Tirupur	Coimbatore
99	Tamil Nadu	Trichy	Madurai
100	Tamil Nadu	Vellore	Chennai
101	Tamil Nadu	Villupuram	Chennai
102	Telangana	Karimnagar	Hyderabad
103	Telangana	Nalgonda	Hyderabad
104	Telangana	Warangal	Hyderabad
105	Uttar Pradesh	Aligarh	Delhi NCR
106	Uttar Pradesh	Bareilly	Lucknow
107	Uttar Pradesh	Faizabad	Lucknow
108	Uttar Pradesh	Ghaziabad / Noida	Delhi NCR
109	Uttar Pradesh	Gonda	Lucknow
110	Uttar Pradesh	Gorakhpur	Varanasi
111	Uttar Pradesh	Jhansi	Agra
112	Uttar Pradesh	Kheri	Lucknow
113	Uttar Pradesh	Mau	Varanasi
114	Uttar Pradesh	Meerut	Delhi NCR

S.No	Circle	L2 Hub	Mapped L1 Hub
115	Uttar Pradesh	Moradabad	Delhi NCR
116	Uttar Pradesh	Prayagraj	Varanasi
117	Uttar Pradesh	Saharanpur	Dehradun
118	Uttarakhand	Haridwar	Dehradun
119	Uttarakhand	Rudrapur	Delhi NCR
120	West Bengal	Port Blair	Chennai / Kolkata
121	West Bengal	Bankura	Durgapur
122	West Bengal	Berhampore	Durgapur
123	West Bengal	Burdwan	Durgapur
124	West Bengal	Howrah	Kolkata
125	West Bengal	Kharagpur	Kolkata
126	West Bengal	Malda	Siliguri
127	West Bengal	Sealdah	Kolkata

Tamil Nadu Circle — Quick Map (MPOP)

For ready reference (relevant to Tamil Nadu Circle aspirants):

- **L1 hubs in Tamil Nadu:** Chennai, Madurai, Coimbatore (3).
- **L2 hubs mapped to Chennai L1:** Vellore, Villupuram (and Port Blair, jointly with Kolkata); from AP — Cuddapah, Nellore, Tirupati.
- **L2 hubs mapped to Madurai L1:** Karaikudi, Thanjavur, Tirunelveli, Trichy.
- **L2 hubs mapped to Coimbatore L1:** Erode, Salem, Tirupur (and from Kerala — Kozhikode, Palakkad).
- **Mapped to Bengaluru L1 (Karnataka):** Dharmapuri, Jolarpettai.

Key Directorate decisions affecting Tamil Nadu

Salem is **not** retained as an L1 — Coimbatore (~2 hrs away) is being developed as a semi-automated hub to handle its volumes.

Tiruchirappalli (Trichy) is **not** retained as L1 — Madurai (~125 km) can handle its TD mail with D+1 delivery; volumes/profile do not justify L1.

Dindigul, Tuticorin, Nagercoil and Mayiladuthurai are **not** retained as L2 hubs — Dindigul/Tuticorin/Nagercoil are close to Madurai, and Mayiladuthurai is close to Chennai, all handled there with sharper SLAs.

On the mail side, **NSH Tirunelveli was downgraded to ICH** w.e.f. 15.11.2025 (Phase-1).

Illustrative Directorate Reasoning (selected circles)

- **Bihar:** Patna planned as a fully-automated hub (5–10K parcels/hr); Muzaffarpur retained as **L2** (TD sorted at Muzaffarpur L2, NTD routed directly to Patna L1).
- **Delhi NCR:** to have **one mega fully-automated hub** with air + surface connectivity; Gurgaon, Noida/Ghaziabad retained as **L2** for LTD volumes; an Integrated Hub (Domestic + International) proposed under PLIP.
- **J&K:** **Leh not retained** as an independent L1 — mapped under two L1 hubs (Srinagar and Delhi) for efficiency.
- **Jharkhand:** **Jamshedpur downgraded to L2**, mapped to Ranchi L1; direct closure to Kolkata only if volume > 1 FTL/day.
- **Kerala:** Thiruvananthapuram retained as **L2**; **Kozhikode not retained as L1** — mapped as L2 to Coimbatore L1.

- **North-East:** state-capital hubs
(Dimapur/Itanagar/Shillong/Agartala/Aizawl/Imphal) handle ~800–1000
parcels/day; **L2–L2 bagging allowed as an exception** in the NE region.

Quick Revision Capsule

Item	Key Fact
MNOP launched	11th Plan scheme, March 2010; adopted Nov 2010 (McKinsey support)
MNOP KPIs	11 unique KPIs; reviewed fortnightly on Central Server
D+X (NTD) / (TD)	Avg 2 days / 1.28 days
TD scans / NTD scans	8 scans / 12 scans (BNPL: 5 / 9)
PNOP launched / vision	17.08.2018; capture 15% of CEP market by 2026
Parcel hubs (legacy / current)	189 PHs = 79 NPH/L1 + ~109–110 PH/L2 (as on 01.04.2025)
NDCs	233 NDCs, 145 cities, 1600+ PINs
Parcel KPIs	33 KPIs (CEPT/CSI)
Trans-shipment centres	9 RTN centres
BYOD (25.06.2025)	₹300 device + ₹200 SIM = ₹500/month; ≥90% via IMA
MPOP	MNOP+PNOP merged; McKinsey (Nov 2024); workshop 11.12.2025
NSH → ICH Phase-1	OM 30-37/2025-D dated 29.10.2025; 20 NSHs w.e.f. 15.11.2025
NSH → ICH Phase-2	File Mail-30-37/2025-D dated 28.01.2026; 27 NSHs w.e.f. 03.02.2026
Finalized parcel network	40 L1 + 127 L2 (F.No.39-04/2025-PD, 17.10.2025); L1 capped ≤45
MPOP design	State-agnostic; direct PIN-to-L1; tied to PLIP (~5 yrs); ~3.5L → ~35L parcels/day
IDC (16-01/2025-D, 14.01.2025)	50–80 beats; 50 greenfield + 1,800 brownfield; 1,500–3,000 sq.ft; 2025-29; NDCs merge into IDC
Delivery Centres (DCs)	~2,000 DCs over 5 yrs; delivery offices ~19,500 → ~12,000
PO Regulations 2024	All parcels accountable; ordinary parcel discontinued
Product rationalization	Gazette Resn. 218 dated 18.08.2025 (w.e.f. 01.10.2025); '24/48 Speed Post'
TN L1 hubs	Chennai, Madurai, Coimbatore (3)

